3.8 Pleural Effusion

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cannot take a deep breath." **Objective** • Affected side moves less with breathing • Dull to percussion • No breath sounds at the base • SpO_2 91%	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective breathing pattern** related to reduced lung expansion from pleural fluid as evidenced by dyspnea and reduced breath sounds.	After drainage, RR 12–20/min and SpO_2 94% or more.	• Sit her upright. • Give oxygen as prescribed. • Get her ready for thoracentesis: explain it, then sit her up leaning forward over a table. • Watch vital signs and SpO_2 during the procedure and afterwards. • Record how much fluid comes off and what it looks like.	Breathing easier after drainage: **goal met**.
Subjective • "The side of my chest hurts when I breathe." **Objective** • Guarding • Breathing shallow	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to pleural inflammation as evidenced by pain on breathing and shallow respiration.	Pain 3/10 or less within 1 hour of analgesia.	• Give analgesia as prescribed and check again after 30–60 minutes. • Have her hold a pillow against her chest when she coughs. • If lying on the affected side eases the pain, position her that way. • Once the analgesia works, teach slow deep breathing.	Pain controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Has had a thoracentesis	**RISK** **Risk for injury** as evidenced by risk factors: invasive procedure (pneumothorax, bleeding, re-expansion pulmonary edema).	No complications after the thoracentesis.	• After the procedure, watch for sudden breathlessness, chest pain or a drop in SpO_2. • Arrange a chest X-ray as ordered. • Check the puncture site for bleeding.	No complications: **goal met**.